MORTADELLA AND RICOTTA FILLING

INGREDIENTS

120 g	Mortadella, in one piece
604 g	Ricotta
30 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	Nutmeg, whole
3/4 tsp	Salt

METHOD

1. Chill the meat grinder and its small die in the refrigerator at least 1 hour, or 30 minutes in the freezer.
2. Fit the small die and run the mortadella through twice.
3. Push the ricotta through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer set over a small bowl. Add the mortadella and the parmigiano and stir until evenly blended.
4. Grate in 5 or 6 passes of nutmeg, stir, and taste. Adjust to suit, keeping it in the background.
5. Season with the salt and taste again. Mortadellas vary in salt and spice, so more may be needed. Aim for properly seasoned. Cover it and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

Nutmeg blooms as the pasta cooks, so it should read as restrained in the raw mixture rather than forward.
The ratio is what matters. Mortadella is there to lend salt and savor to the ricotta, not to take it over.
Passing the ricotta through a tamis is what makes the filling smooth enough to pipe cleanly.
The 3/4 tsp of salt is a starting point only, because different mortadellas arrive at very different salt levels.
The mixture is loose and delicate. Pasta filled with it wants a gentle simmer, not a rolling boil.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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